

Iranian Fresh Apples

Gala · Golden Delicious · Red Delicious · Granny Smith · Fuji. Fresh whole fruit, specified and packed for the European Union market.



IDENTITY

BOTANICAL NAME

Malus domestica

HS CODE

0808.10

ORIGIN

Iran

PRODUCT FORM

Fresh, whole fruit

VARIETIES

Five

MARKET

European Union

HARVEST

Aug – Nov

CALIBRE

65 – 100 mm

CLASSES

Extra / I / II

Five varieties, one export specification.

The commercial specification below is common to all five. What changes between them is colour, texture, sugar, firmness and — most usefully for planning — the week they come off the tree.

MAIN COMMERCIAL VARIETIES

01	02	03	04	05
Gala	Golden Delicious	Red Delicious	Granny Smith	Fuji
Royal Gala. Red striped over cream.	Yellow-green, aromatic.	Deep red, round-conical.	Bright green, firm, acidic.	Pink-red blush, highest sugar.

COMMON EXPORT SPECIFICATION

65–100	Commercial calibre, millimetres	SIZE
One sizing range across all five varieties. Packing is calibre- and buyer-specific.		
80–180	Commercial fruit weight, grams	WEIGHT
Reported Iranian commercial bands are 80–120 g and 130–180 g.		
3	Quality classes	CLASS
Extra, Class I and Class II — to be aligned with UNECE FFV-50 before issue.		
2–7	Months of cold storage	STORAGE
At approximately –1 to +4 °C and 90–95 % RH, depending on variety and handling.		

Figures are drawn from Iranian commercial export specifications and published Iranian research. They are indicative commercial benchmarks for catalogue purposes, not guaranteed values for every orchard or lot. Firmness and soluble solids are variety- and maturity-dependent.

Told apart by colour before anything else.

Colour coverage is a specification field, not a description — it is what a buyer's inspector checks first. Each variety is shown whole, so shape reads as well as colour.



Gala Royal Gala

> 60 % RED

Bright red stripes over a pale green-cream ground. Conical to oblong, fine-grained and crisp.



Golden Delicious

< 10 % BLUSH

Light green to very pale yellow, dry skin. Elongated and tapering, sweet and aromatic.



Red Delicious

> 80 % RED

Dark to striped red, the deepest colour of the five. Round to round-conical, tender and juicy.



Granny Smith

< 10 % BLUSH

Bright green, smooth skin. Elongated, the firmest and most acidic of the five.



Fuji

> 60 % RED BLUSH

Pinkish-red blush over green, yellow flesh. Slightly elongated, flattened at base and apex.

SHOWN PACKED — STUDIO FRAME PENDING

TWO REDS, NOT ONE

Gala and Red Delicious are not interchangeable: > 60 % striped against > 80 % solid, and a different flesh and bite.

TWO GREENS, NOT ONE

Golden Delicious is sweet and aromatic; Granny Smith is acidic and markedly firmer. Different programmes.

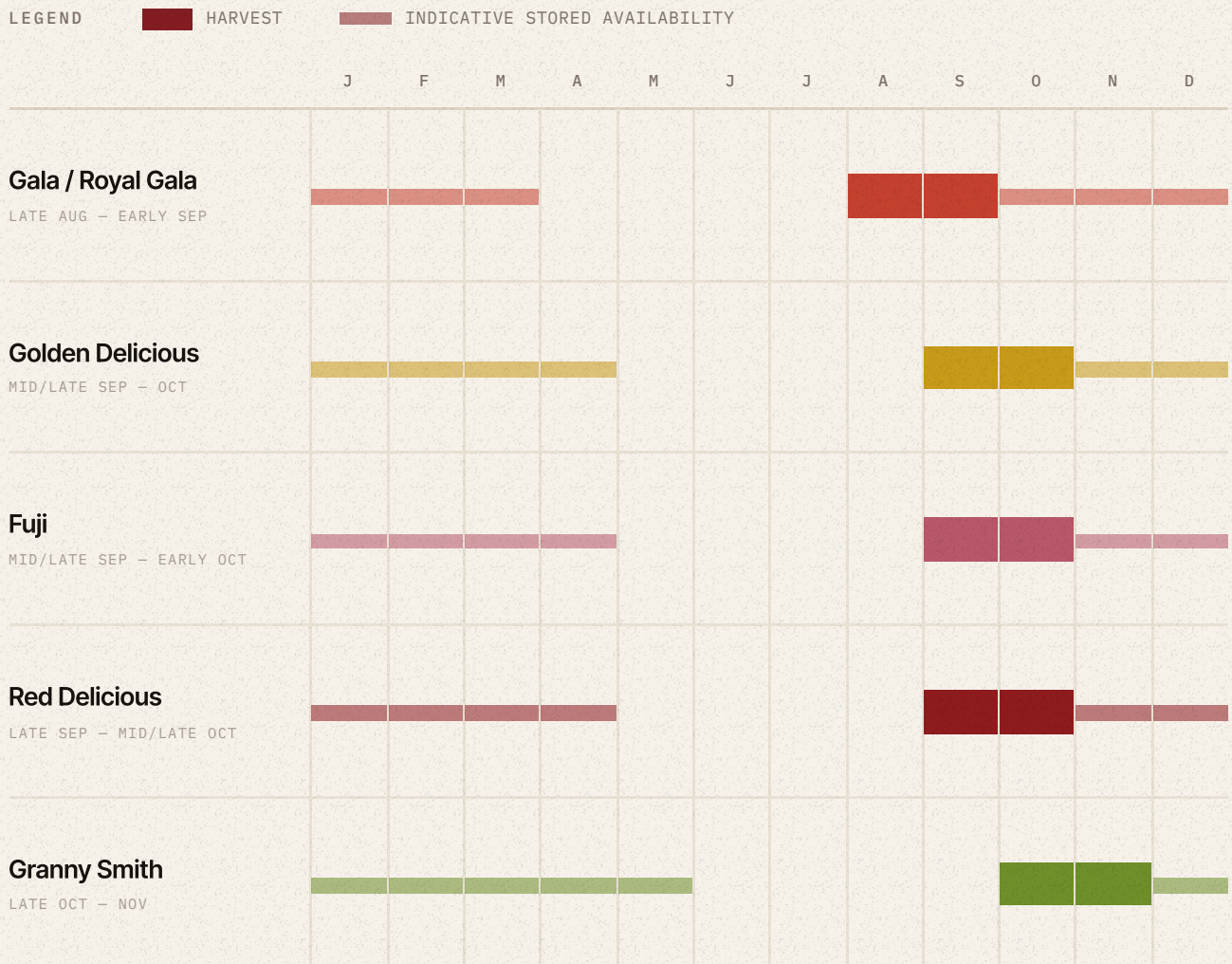
FUJI SITS BETWEEN

Blush rather than stripe, and the highest sugar benchmark of the five at ≥ 14.0 °Brix.

Colour, appearance and sensory characteristics are taken from an Iranian commercial specification. Photography of Fuji as a single fruit is outstanding; the frame shown is packed export fruit.

The five varieties ripen in sequence.

Roughly ten weeks separate the first Gala from the last Granny Smith. That sequence, plus storage, is what turns five varieties into a programme rather than five separate purchases.



PROGRAMME, NOT SPOT

A buyer taking Gala in September and Granny Smith in November holds one supplier and one specification across the autumn.

STORAGE DOES THE REST

Stored availability extends supply from autumn into spring — 2 to 7 months, depending on variety and handling.

WINDOWS MOVE

Harvest dates shift year to year with the season. We commit to dates we can hold, not to the calendar.

Harvest windows are approximate, from Iranian commercial sources. Stored availability is shown indicatively at six months from the end of harvest; the underlying source states 2–7 months depending on variety and handling, and does not publish a per-variety storage figure.

Gala / Royal Gala

HARVEST • LATE AUG — EARLY SEP



FIG. 01 — Gala. Bright red stripes over a pale green-cream ground.



FIG. 02 — Gala in the orchard.

COLOUR	Pale green / cream ground with bright red stripes
COLOUR COVERAGE	> 60 % red
FLESH	White to cream
SHAPE	Conical to oblong
TEXTURE	Fine-grained, tender, crisp and juicy
TASTE	Sweet, with a mild tangy balance
SKIN	Smooth
CALIBRE	65 – 100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80 – 180 g
QUALITY CLASSES	Extra / Class I / Class II

MATURITY

Brix benchmark $\geq 12.0^\circ$
Firmness 5.8 – 6.0 kg, 11-mm plunger.

A separate Iranian study of Gala reported TSS around $14.6 \pm 0.6^\circ$ Brix — which is why this catalogue gives a benchmark rather than a promised value.

SEASON

Late August → early September
The first of the five off the tree.

Stored availability extends through autumn into spring, subject to the storage programme.

Golden Delicious

HARVEST · MID/LATE SEP – OCT



FIG. 03 — Golden Delicious. Light green to very pale yellow.



FIG. 04 — Golden Delicious at harvest.

COLOUR	Light green to very pale yellow
BLUSH	< 10 %
FLESH	Creamy, slightly green
SHAPE	Elongated / tapering
TEXTURE	Crisp, juicy
TASTE	Sweet, aromatic
SKIN	Dry
CALIBRE	65 – 100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80 – 180 g
QUALITY CLASSES	Extra / Class I / Class II

MATURITY

Brix benchmark $\geq 12.8^{\circ}$
Firmness 5.8 – 6.0 kg, 11-mm
plunger.

The highest sugar benchmark of
the three mid-season varieties.

SEASON

**Mid / late September →
October**

Stored availability can extend
significantly beyond harvest
depending on storage conditions.

Red Delicious

HARVEST • LATE SEP – MID/LATE OCT



FIG. 05 — Red Delicious. The deepest colour of the five.



FIG. 06 — Red Delicious in the orchard.

COLOUR	Dark red / striped red
COLOUR COVERAGE	> 80 % red
FLESH	White
SHAPE	Round to round-conical
TEXTURE	Fine-grained, tender, juicy
TASTE	Sweet, mild
SKIN	Fairly smooth and dry
CALIBRE	65 – 100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80 – 180 g
QUALITY CLASSES	Extra / Class I / Class II

MATURITY

≈ 12 – 13 °Brix at commercial maturity
Firmness 5.8 – 6.0 kg, 11-mm plunger.

An Iranian post-harvest study selected commercially mature fruit at approximately 12–13 °Brix and 80–90 % red surface coverage — a range, not a single value.

SEASON

Late September → mid / late October

Iranian commercial sources show Red Delicious in the stored export calendar through winter and into spring.

Granny Smith

HARVEST · LATE OCT – NOV



FIG. 07 — Granny Smith. Bright green, smooth skin.



FIG. 08 — Granny Smith on the tree.

COLOUR	Bright green
BLUSH	< 10 % pink / orange permitted in the cited specification
FLESH	Greenish-white
SHAPE	Elongated / tapering
TEXTURE	Crisp, firm
TASTE	Sweet-tangy / acidic
SKIN	Smooth
CALIBRE	65 – 100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80 – 180 g
QUALITY CLASSES	Extra / Class I / Class II

MATURITY

Brix benchmark $\geq 11.0^\circ$
Firmness **6.3 – 6.5 kg**, 11-mm plunger.

The lowest sugar and the highest firmness of the five — the combination that makes it the long-storage and processing variety.

SEASON

Late October → November
The latest of the five.

Closes the Iranian autumn programme and carries supply furthest into the following year.

Fuji

HARVEST • MID/LATE SEP – EARLY OCT



FIG. 09 — Fuji, packed for export. A single-fruit studio frame is outstanding for this variety.



FIG. 10 — Fuji orchard under protective netting.

COLOUR	Pinkish-red blush over green
COLOUR COVERAGE	> 60 % red blush
FLESH	Yellow
SHAPE	Slightly elongated, flattened at base and apex
TEXTURE	Crisp and juicy
TASTE	Sweet, aromatic
SKIN	Smooth
CALIBRE	65 – 100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80 – 180 g
QUALITY CLASSES	Extra / Class I / Class II

MATURITY

Brix benchmark $\geq 14.0^{\circ}$
Firmness 5.6 – 5.8 kg, 11-mm plunger.

The highest sugar benchmark and the softest firmness benchmark of the five.

SEASON

Mid / late September – early October

Iranian commercial data places Fuji after Gala, around the same general period as the other mid / late autumn varieties.

Sugar and firmness, side by side.

These are benchmarks, not guarantees. They exist so a buyer can see how the varieties differ from each other — which is the question the numbers can actually answer.



A solid mark is the benchmark minimum; the tint to its right is “at or above”. Red Delicious is given as a measured range. The grey mark on Gala is the 14.6 °Brix reported by a separate Iranian study — evidence that one fixed value would be a promise we could not keep.



Measured with an 11-mm plunger. Granny Smith stands clearly apart at 6.3–6.5 kg; Fuji is the softest of the five. Firmness is variety- and maturity-dependent and is confirmed per lot.

WHY A BENCHMARK, NOT A VALUE

Sugar and firmness move with orchard, season and harvest date. A single promised number would fail on some lots and mislead on the rest.

SET THE ACCEPTANCE LIMITS

Final acceptance limits are agreed with the buyer against the storage programme and destination, then measured per lot.

TWO ENDS OF ONE RANGE

Fuji at ≥14 °Brix and Granny Smith at ≥11 °Brix are three full points apart. They are not substitutes for each other.

Benchmarks combine Iranian commercial specifications with published Iranian research and should be treated as indicative, not as guaranteed values for every orchard or lot.

One sizing table, all five varieties.

Rather than invent a separate calibre scale per variety, the catalogue uses a single commercial sizing table across the range — which is how the fruit is actually sorted.

COMMERCIAL SIZE	APPROX. FRUIT WEIGHT	TYPICAL USE
65 – 70 mm	approx. 80 – 100 g	Wholesale and price-sensitive markets
70 – 75 mm	approx. 100 – 120 g	Wholesale and retail
75 – 80 mm	approx. 120 – 140 g	Retail
80 – 90 mm	approx. 140 – 160 g	Premium retail
90 – 100 mm	approx. 160 – 180 g	Premium and selected retail

THIS TABLE IS A WORKING SPECIFICATION

The Iranian source publishes the overall 65–100 mm range and the common weight bands, but does not publish a weight for each calibre. The diameter-to-weight conversions above must be confirmed against PAYA ORIGIN's own sorting data before this becomes a product commitment.

UNIFORMITY INSIDE THE PACKAGE

UNECE FFV-50 permits sizing by diameter or by weight and sets limits on uniformity within a package. For fruit packed in rows and layers, the difference in diameter must not exceed 5 mm; the standard sets corresponding bands and tolerances for weight-based sizing.

DECLARED PER SHIPMENT

Calibre and class are declared per shipment on the carton label, together with net weight and fruit count. Where a consignment mixes sizes, the declaration follows the pack.

The core promise, before the classes.

Class describes presentation. Everything on this list applies to all three classes — it is the floor, not the grade.

FRESH APPLES SHALL BE

Sound and clean	REQUIRED	Rot and mould	NOT PERMITTED
Firm and commercially mature	REQUIRED	Significant bruising	NOT PERMITTED
Suitable for long-distance transport	REQUIRED	Insect damage	NOT PERMITTED
Suitable for subsequent storage and marketing	REQUIRED	Foreign material	NOT PERMITTED
		Abnormal external moisture	NOT PERMITTED

QUALITY CLASSES

Extra

Premium presentation, with stricter appearance requirements than the classes below.

Class I

Good commercial quality, with permitted minor defects within the applicable standard tolerances.

Class II

Meets minimum market requirements and the applicable tolerances. Sound fruit, correctly declared.

TO BE ALIGNED BEFORE ISSUE

For the European Union market these class definitions must be reconciled with **UNECE FFV-50** — the marketing standard for apples, listed by UNECE as FFV-50 with a revised 2020 edition — before this catalogue is issued to buyers.

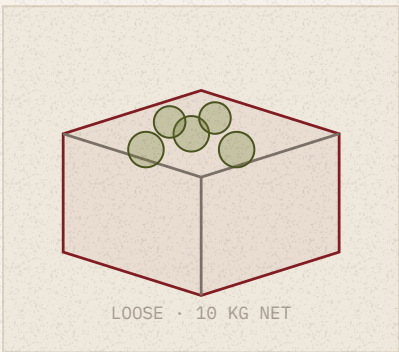
TEN WEEKS

Five varieties, one autumn.

From the first Gala in late August to the last Granny Smith in November, the Iranian apple season runs as one continuous programme.

Three levels, all buyer-specific.

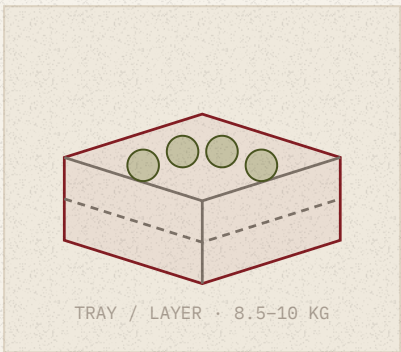
The 10 kg carton is the standard Iranian export pack. Everything above and below it is built to the buyer's requirement.



LEVEL A · BULK

10 kg carton

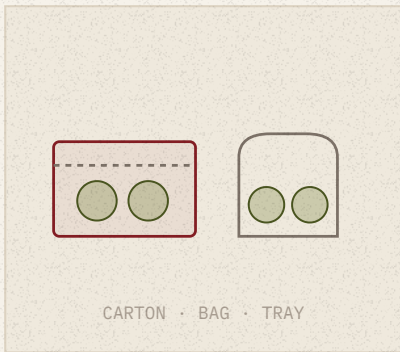
Loose packed. The standard Iranian export format, reported across commercial sources.



LEVEL B · WHOLESALE

8.5 / 10 kg

Tray or layer packing, or customer-specific. Plastic boxes at 8.5 and 13.5 kg are also reported by Iranian exporters.



LEVEL C · RETAIL

Buyer-specific

Retail carton, bag, tray or consumer pack to the customer's specification and artwork.



FIG. 11 — 10 kg export carton, cell-packed. Board, count and artwork are agreed with the buyer.

WHY THESE ARE DRAWN, NOT PHOTOGRAPHED

The packed photography on file carries another company's labels on every fruit. Rather than put a competitor's brand into a PAYA ORIGIN catalogue, the three formats are drawn and one sticker-free carton is shown. A short packing-line session would replace all three drawings with real photographs of PAYA's own pack.

CARTON SPECIFICATION

Material	FOOD-GRADE CORRUGATED	Fruit count	BUYER-SPECIFIC
Ventilation	SUITABLE FOR REFRIGERATED TRANSPORT	Calibre	DECLARED PER SHIPMENT
Net weight	BUYER-SPECIFIC	Class	DECLARED PER SHIPMENT

Packaging formats are reported by Iranian commercial exporters. Final carton dimensions, board grade and artwork are agreed with the buyer and approved before the first carton is printed.

From carton to container.

Pallet configuration follows the carton, and the container count follows the pallet. None of the three can be quoted before the first is fixed.

PALLET

Target format EURO PALLET 1200 × 800 MM

Configuration PER CARTON DIMENSIONS AND BUYER REQUIREMENT

CONTAINER

Type 40-FOOT REFRIGERATED (REEFER)

Loading PER CARTON FORMAT, PALLET PATTERN, MAX PAYLOAD

Alternative pallet formats may be used according to destination or customer requirement. Pallet treatment and marking comply with applicable international requirements.

TARGET PALLET • 1200 × 800 MM

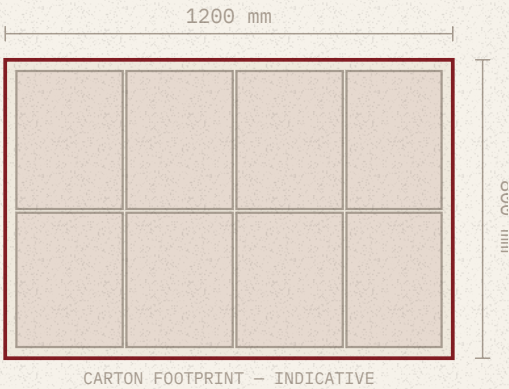


FIG. 11 — Fruit in crates ahead of grading and packing.

CARTON FIRST

Dimensions and board grade are agreed with the buyer; the pallet plan is derived from them.

THEN THE PALLET

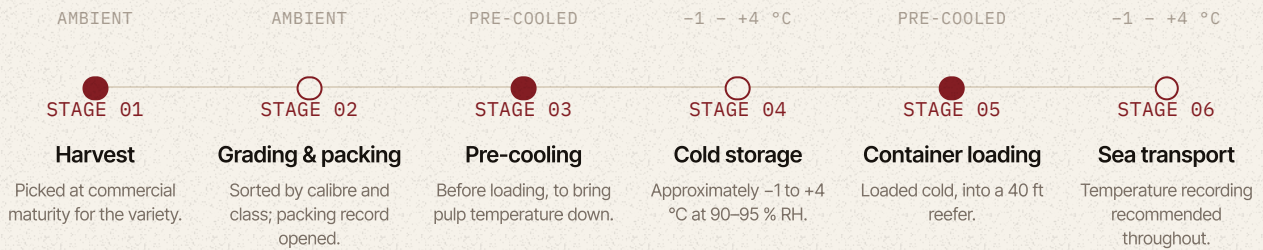
Cartons per layer and layers per pallet, chosen for stability and airflow together.

THEN THE CONTAINER

Total cartons and net and gross weight per container, reconciled against the payload limit.

Two to seven months is a range, and it is earned.

Storage life for Iranian apples is reported at 2–7 months depending on variety and handling. Which end of that range a lot reaches is decided before it goes into store, not after.



WHAT DECIDES THE STORAGE OUTCOME

Variety, harvest maturity, speed into pre-cooling, storage temperature and humidity stability, and whether the chain is broken at any hand-off. Granny Smith and Red Delicious sit at the long end of the range; earlier, softer varieties do not.

RECORDS

Temperature recording through storage and transit is recommended and is provided where the buyer requires it. A cold-chain record is part of the shipment documentation set on page 17.

STORAGE TEMPERATURE

-1 to +4 °C

RELATIVE HUMIDITY

90 – 95 %

PRE-COOLING

Before loading

STORAGE LIFE

2 – 7 months

Compliance and documentation, kept separate from the fruit.

What follows applies to every variety and every shipment, which is why it is set out once here rather than repeated on five variety pages.

COMPLIANCE

- | | |
|----|---|
| 01 | EU phytosanitary requirements
Met per shipment and per destination, with the required certificate accompanying the consignment. |
| 02 | EU Maximum Residue Levels
Full compliance, supported by accredited laboratory residue analysis. |
| 03 | GLOBALG.A.P. and GRASP
Where applicable to the production base. |
| 04 | Packhouse certification
BRCGS, IFS or FSSC 22000, according to buyer requirements, on a HACCP-based food-safety system. |
| 05 | Buyer-specific certificates
Additional certificates and declarations as the buyer's programme requires. |

EXPORT DOCUMENTATION

Phytosanitary certificate	PER SHIPMENT
Packing / grading record	PER LOT
Commercial invoice	PER SHIPMENT
Packing list	PER SHIPMENT
Certificates of analysis	AS REQUIRED
Temperature / cold-chain record	RECOMMENDED
Buyer-specific documents	ON REQUEST

NAMED, NOT IMPLIED

Certification held is named explicitly per shipment. Where a buyer's programme requires a certificate we do not hold, we say so before contracting rather than after inspection.

RESIDUE TARGET

No MRL exceedance

CERTIFICATE

Per destination

LAB REPORTS

Accredited

STANDARD

UNECE FFV-50

All five, one page.

The page to send when a buyer asks for the specification and does not want a nineteen-page document.

	Gala	Golden Delicious	Red Delicious	Granny Smith	Fuji
PRODUCT	Fresh apple	Fresh apple	Fresh apple	Fresh apple	Fresh apple
ORIGIN	Iran	Iran	Iran	Iran	Iran
HS CODE	0808.10	0808.10	0808.10	0808.10	0808.10
COLOUR	Red striped	Yellow-green	Deep red	Bright green	Pink-red
COVERAGE	> 60 %	< 10 % blush	> 80 %	< 10 % blush	> 60 % red
FLESH	White / cream	Creamy	White	Greenish-white	Yellow
SHAPE	Conical-oblong	Elongated	Round-conical	Elongated	Slightly elongated
TEXTURE	Crisp / juicy	Crisp / juicy	Tender / juicy	Firm / crisp	Crisp / juicy
TASTE	Sweet, mild tang	Sweet, aromatic	Sweet, mild	Tangy-sweet	Sweet
CALIBRE	65–100 mm	65–100 mm	65–100 mm	65–100 mm	65–100 mm
FRUIT WEIGHT	80–180 g	80–180 g	80–180 g	80–180 g	80–180 g
BRIX BENCHMARK	≥ 12.0°	≥ 12.8°	≈ 12–13°	≥ 11.0°	≥ 14.0°
FIRMNESS	5.8–6.0 kg	5.8–6.0 kg	5.8–6.0 kg	6.3–6.5 kg	5.6–5.8 kg
HARVEST WINDOW	Late Aug – early Sep	Mid/late Sep – Oct	Late Sep – mid/late Oct	Late Oct – Nov	Mid/late Sep – early Oct
STORAGE	2–7 months*	2–7 months*	2–7 months*	2–7 months*	2–7 months*
STORAGE TEMP.	–1 to +4 °C*	–1 to +4 °C*	–1 to +4 °C*	–1 to +4 °C*	–1 to +4 °C*
RELATIVE HUMIDITY	90–95 %*	90–95 %*	90–95 %*	90–95 %*	90–95 %*
QUALITY CLASS	Extra / I / II	Extra / I / II	Extra / I / II	Extra / I / II	Extra / I / II
PACKAGING	Buyer-specific	Buyer-specific	Buyer-specific	Buyer-specific	Buyer-specific

* Common to all five varieties: storage duration, temperature and humidity are reported as a single commercial range, with the source stating that storage life varies by variety and handling. Brix and firmness are indicative benchmarks, not guaranteed values. Diameter-to-weight conversions and class definitions remain to be confirmed against PAYA ORIGIN sorting data and UNECE FFV-50.

IRANIAN FRESH APPLES · FIVE VARIETIES · EU MARKET

Tell us the variety, the calibre and the month. We will tell you what the season can hold.

This catalogue is a commercial summary built on Iranian commercial export specifications and published Iranian research. Before issue to buyers, three items are to be confirmed: the diameter-to-weight sizing table against PAYA ORIGIN's own sorting data, the class definitions against UNECE FFV-50, and the per-variety storage figures.

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